

FEDERAL LAUNCH KIT

Win Your First Federal Contract.

INSIDE THIS MANUAL ↓

- ✓ **Get Registered** · SAM.gov + certifications
- ✓ **Build Identity** · Cap statement + past perf
- ✓ **Find & Bid** · Sources sought to RFP
- ✓ **Win & Keep** · Price, submit, stay compliant

THE FOUR-TOOL SYSTEM

01

Get Registered

SAM.gov + certifications

02

Build Identity

Cap statement + past perf

03

Find & Bid

Sources sought to RFP

04

Win & Keep

Price, submit, stay compliant

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Start Here

Alright, so you've got the Federal Launch Kit. Think of this as your map for navigating federal contracting, from zero to your first contract award. It's not a magic bullet, and anyone telling you it is, is lying. This work takes time, usually six to twelve months before you see a real return, but it's absolutely learnable if you follow a proven path. We built this kit to give you that path, cutting through the noise and getting you straight to what works.

You've got a few ways to use this. You can read this "Start Here" guide first, then just work your way through the phases one by one. Each phase has its own set of templates and a quick one-page guide explaining how to use them. Or, if you know exactly what you need, just flip to the Master Template List at the back. Grab the specific document or tool you're after and get to work. No fluff, just the tools and guidance you need to get your firm winning federal dollars.

The path, in six phases

Phase 1 • Get Registered & Certified

Phase 1 is all about getting your firm officially recognized. You'll get your [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov) registration active and lock in any set-aside certifications, like SDVOSB or 8(a). This usually takes about 4-8 weeks, sometimes longer if you hit a snag with SAM.

- **SAM.gov Registration.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/sam-registration>
- **Certification Eligibility.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/certifications>

Phase 2 • Build Your Federal Identity

Here, you'll build the core documents needed to introduce your firm. That means crafting a sharp capability statement and compiling your past performance write-ups. Plan on spending 2-4 weeks to get these solid.

- **Capability Statement.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/capability-statement>
- **Past Performance.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/past-performance>

Phase 3 • Find & Qualify the Right Work

This phase teaches you how to find real opportunities and quickly decide if they're worth your time. You'll learn to use tools like [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov) and FPDS to identify good fits and avoid wasting effort on bad leads. Getting good at this takes practice, but you'll start seeing results in 3-6 weeks.

- **Market Research.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/market-research>
- **Sources Sought & RFI.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/sources-sought>
- **Pre-Solicitation Window.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/pre-solicitation>
- **Bid / No-Bid Decision.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/bid-no-bid>

Phase 4 • Reach Out & Position

Now you'll learn how to get on the radar of federal buyers and contracting officers before an RFP even drops. This involves targeted outreach and relationship building. Expect to dedicate ongoing effort here, but initial connections can be made in 4-6 weeks.

- **Contracting Officer Outreach.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/co-outreach>

Phase 5 • Price, Bid & Win

This is where you put together a winning proposal. You'll learn how to price competitively, respond precisely to the solicitation, and review your bid like an evaluator would. Proposal development can take anywhere from 2-8 weeks, depending on the opportunity size.

- **Price-to-Win.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/price-to-win>
- **RFP / Solicitation Response.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/rfp-response>
- **RFQ Quoting.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/rfq>
- **IDIQ / GWAC Task Orders.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/idiq>
- **Teaming & Subcontracting.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/teaming>
- **Capture Maturity Self-Audit.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/capture-maturity>
- **FAR Clause Decoder.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/far-decoder>

Phase 6 • After You Win

Winning a contract is just the start; this phase covers what comes next. You'll ensure compliance, manage your project, and secure a strong CPARS rating for future work. This is an ongoing process throughout the life of your contract.

- **Post-Award Compliance.** Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/post-award>

Bonus • Founder Onboarding Call

A free 30-minute call with our capture lead, included with the kit. Book it once you've picked a target:
<https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/founder-call>

This kit comes out of three years of running federal capture at Americurial. The templates are the ones we actually use with clients. Work the phases in order the first time. After that, treat it as a reference and jump to whatever you need.